League Management Mobile App — PRD

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Overview

A mobile app that automates running a social football league: team sign-up, fixture confirmation, cancellations and rescheduling, payments, field bookings and player sourcing, with every team payment tracked in a built-in finance view.

Problem. League managers (Admins at Old Parks) spend hours chasing teams to confirm fixtures and pay, and lose revenue when matches fall through at short notice. Captains struggle to know who will turn up. Payment is tracked by hand, often with physical tokens at the gate.

Solution. Role-based push notifications drive every step of the match lifecycle. Matches that cannot go ahead are cancelled, replaced or converted to friendlies automatically, hours or days in advance. Payment is taken in-app (or confirmed by Admin for cash) and proven at the gate with a scannable Payment Barcode.

Target customer. Venue operators and league managers running weekly 5-a-side style leagues across multiple nights and divisions, who may already have a website, fixtures system or accounting package.

Goals and success metrics

The app succeeds when scheduled fixtures reliably happen, teams pay without being chased, and Admin workload drops.

Goal	Metric	Target
Fixtures happen as scheduled	% of scheduled slots that end in a played match (league, replacement or friendly)	TBD
Teams pay on time	% of teams with a valid Payment Barcode before kick-off	TBD
Less admin effort	Admin hours per night spent on confirmations, payments and rescheduling	TBD
Recover lost revenue	Friendly-match and booking income per month	TBD
Players respond	% of Confirmation Notifications answered before the 6-hour cutoff	TBD

Non-goals (v1)

- Replacing an existing league website or results platform; we integrate with it instead.
- Full accounting in phase 1 (expenses, invoices, VAT, bank reconciliation); the finance tracker covers income only and exports it for the club's accountant.
- Removing cash payments; cash stays supported through Admin confirmation.

Phasing

Phase 1 ships the match lifecycle with a basic in-app finance tracker; Xero moves to phase 2, so a club can launch with no accounting setup or extra subscription.

Area	Phase 1	Phase 2
Team payments	Tracked in the in-app finance tracker	Also synced to Xero
Booking and friendly income	Shown in the finance tracker	Also synced to Xero
Accountant hand-off	CSV / Excel export	Xero, or other packages through Xero

User roles and permissions

Five roles; a Captain is also a Player, and a Player can be an outfield Player, a Goalkeeper, or both.

Role	Who	Can do
Admin	League managers at Old Parks	Load available Nights and Divisions (e.g. from Excel); confirm or decline Captain requests to create a Team; assign a Captain to a Team; accept Captain cancellation requests; cancel or reschedule fixtures; confirm or decline Booking Notifications; scan Barcodes to confirm Team and Booking User payment; confirm cash payments (no-gateway mode)
Referee	Match officials per pitch	Scan a Barcode to confirm a Team has paid
Captain	Team lead (also a Player)	Request creation of a Team by choosing an available Night and Division; confirm Player requests to join; send a cancel/postpone request to Admin; receive the Payment Barcode; raise a Player or Goalkeeper Request when short
Player	Registered player	Search for and request to join a Team; choose which Nights to get notifications for; accept or decline Confirmation Notifications; receive Reminder and Player Request Notifications; join another Team's match via a Player/Goalkeeper Request
Booking User	Casual field hirer	Pick an available time, field and number of hours; cancel or reschedule the booking; receive a Barcode for entry once approved

Visibility rule: Player Requests are shown only to outfield Players and Goalkeeper Requests only to Goalkeepers, matching each user's chosen position.

Notifications

Push notifications are the app's core mechanism: each one informs a user and, where it carries a button, triggers the next step in the background.

Type	Content	Action	Recipients
Confirmation	Both team names, date and time	Confirm / Decline	Players of a scheduled or newly joinable match

Type	Content	Action	Recipients
Reminder	Date, time and field	None	Players, Captains, Admins, Referees
General	Message (e.g. match cancelled)	Button to find a match in another Team	Players of a cancelled Team
Update	Message only	None	Players, Admins, Referees affected by a change
Player Request	Confirmation format	Accept / Decline to join another Team's match	Outfield Players not in either opposing Team
Goalkeeper Request	Confirmation format	Accept / Decline to join another Team's match	Goalkeepers not in either opposing Team
Booking	Booking details	Confirm / Decline	Admins

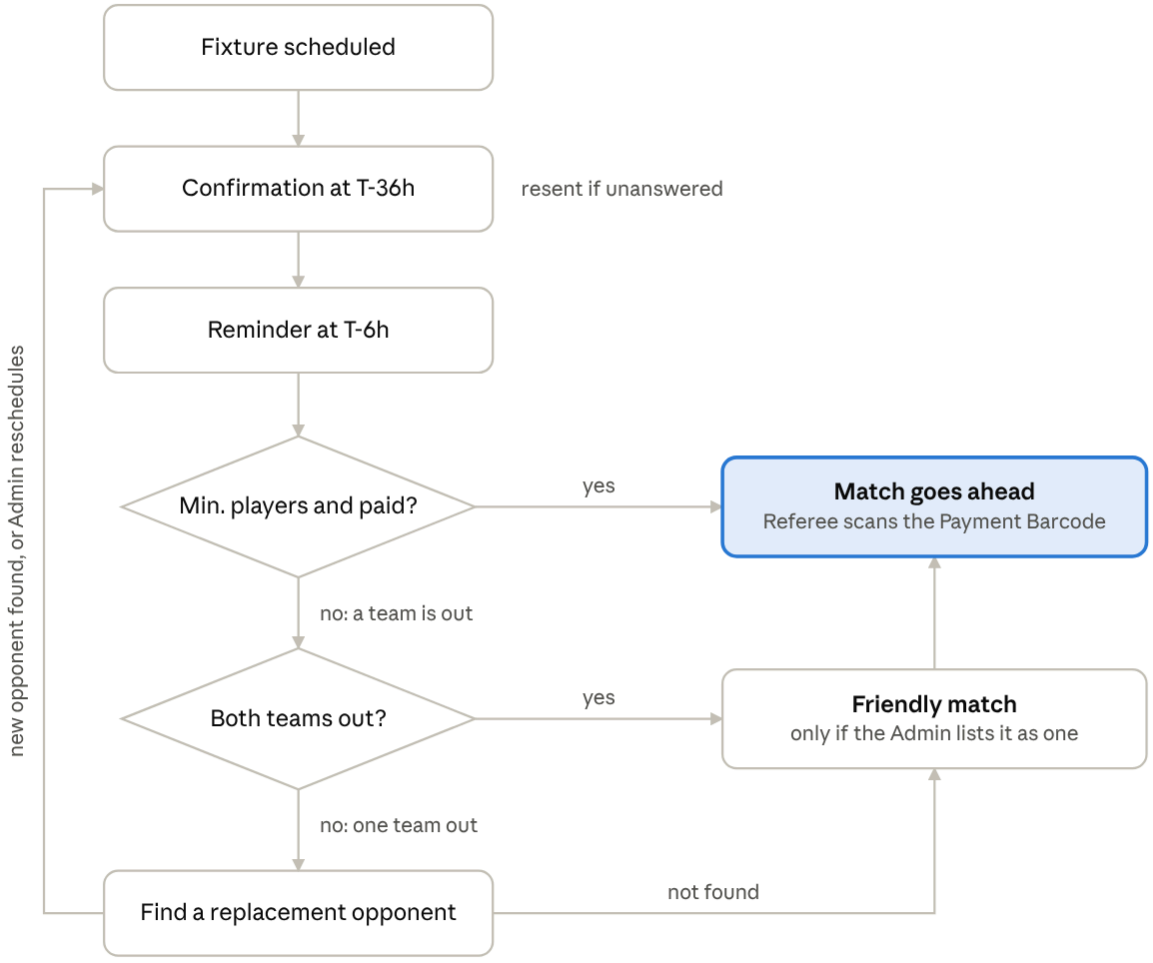
Targeting rules

- Players only receive notifications for the Nights they opted into.
- On a reschedule, only the Admin of the registered Night and the Referee of the affected pitch are notified.
- A Player who answered a Confirmation incorrectly can change their answer in the app.

Match lifecycle

Every fixture runs on two timed checkpoints (T-36h and T-6h before kick-off); a team that drops out triggers a replacement match, and failing that a friendly where the Admin allows it.

A dropped fixture falls back to a replacement match, then a friendly



match lifecycle · 2 checks, 2 fallbacks

A fixture that cannot go ahead is first re-offered to another Team, then opened as a friendly only if the Admin has listed it as friendly-eligible; otherwise it is cancelled and paid Players receive credit.

Confirmation and readiness

1. **FR-1** Send a Confirmation Notification to every Player of both Teams 36 hours before kick-off.
2. **FR-2** Resend the Confirmation once if the Player has not accepted or declined.
3. **FR-3** Let a Player change their accept/decline answer in the app at any time before the cutoff.
4. **FR-4** Send a Reminder Notification (date, time, field) 6 hours before kick-off.
5. **FR-5** At T-6h, cancel a Team's participation if fewer Players have confirmed than the Division's minimum (configurable per Division; default 5).

6. **FR-6** A Team may only play with a valid Payment Barcode. At T-6h the Admin (manager) decides whether an unpaid Team is out, including Teams still expected to pay cash at the gate.

Admin reschedule (the process restarts)

1. **FR-7** Send an Update Notification to Players of both rescheduled Teams.
2. **FR-8** Send an Update Notification to the Admin of the registered Night and the Referee of the affected pitch only.
3. **FR-9** If the new time is within 36 hours, send Confirmation Notifications immediately.

Both Teams cancel → friendly, only if the Admin has listed the match as friendly-eligible

1. **FR-10** General Notification to Players of the cancelled Teams (match cancelled, with a button to find a match elsewhere).
2. **FR-11** Confirmation Notification to all Players outside the two Teams (match free to join).
3. **FR-12** Notification to Admins and Referees.

One Team cancels → find another opponent

1. **FR-13** General Notification to Players of the cancelled Team.
2. **FR-14** Update Notification to the remaining Team (opponent withdrew, finding a new match).
3. **FR-15** Offer the slot to eligible Teams; the first Team to accept becomes the new opponent and its Players get Confirmation Notifications.
4. **FR-16** Update Notification to Admins and Referees.
5. **FR-17** If no replacement is found and the Admin has listed the match as friendly-eligible, fall back to a friendly (otherwise cancel it and apply FR-43): General Notification to the cancelled Team, Confirmation to all Players outside it, Update to Admins and Referees.

Captain-initiated cancellation

1. **FR-18** A Captain can request a cancellation or postponement; it takes effect only once an Admin accepts it.

Payments, authorisation and accounting

A Team is authorised to play only when its Captain holds a valid Payment Barcode, issued automatically on payment or by an Admin for cash.

Payment gateway

1. **FR-19** Players enter card details and choose how much they pay; contributions sum to the Team total.
2. **FR-20** Once the Team total reaches the amount due, the Team is marked paid.
3. **FR-21** Captains see which Players have paid; Admins see which Teams have paid.
4. **FR-22** Cash paid to the club remains an option alongside card payment.

Barcode authorisation

Mode	How the Barcode is issued	Validity
With payment gateway	Generated automatically when the Team has paid	Per match
Without payment gateway	Admin confirms payment in the app; Barcode sent to the Captain	Rest of the Season

5. **FR-23** Referees and Admins scan the Barcode at the entrance; the app shows whether the Team has paid.
6. **FR-24** Friendly matches charge a specified fee, paid by the borrowed Players, the Team's Players or the club/manager, as the Admin sets per match; a Captain is assigned to receive the Barcode and have it verified.

Cancellations and credit

- **FR-43** When a paid match is cancelled, each Player's payment becomes credit towards a future match; no card refund is issued.

Finance tracker (phase 1)

Admins get a Finances view that shows what each Team owes, what has come in, and what is still outstanding, without any outside accounting software.

7. **FR-25** Season totals per Night and Division: expected (Teams × fee), received, outstanding and credit held, split by card and cash.
8. **FR-26** Team ledger: amount due, paid and outstanding, with every payment line (date, Player, amount, method: card, cash or credit) and who recorded it.
9. **FR-27** Compare income across Leagues and Nights.
10. **FR-47** Planner: expected income week by week for the season, built from the fixture list, with received income overlaid so shortfalls show early.
11. **FR-48** Outstanding list: Teams and Players who owe, largest first, with Remind and Mark cash paid on each.
12. **FR-49** Booking and friendly income shown as separate lines beside league income.

13. **FR-50** Credits, refunds and corrections are added as ledger entries with a reason; entries are never edited or deleted, only reversed.
14. **FR-51** Export any period to CSV or Excel for the club's accountant.

Xero integration (season and booking income synced automatically, 50% off the first three months) moves to phase 2.

Bookings

Casual users can hire a field for a chosen number of hours; an Admin approves each booking and the user enters with a Barcode.

1. **FR-28** Booking Users choose from available fields and times and the number of hours to play.
2. **FR-29** Admins receive a Booking Notification and accept or decline.
3. **FR-30** On acceptance, send a Barcode to the Booking User for scanning at entry.
4. **FR-31** Booking Users can cancel or reschedule the time, field and hours booked.

With payment gateway only

5. **FR-32** Booking Users sign up with payment credentials.
6. **FR-33** Price = hourly fee × hours booked.
7. **FR-34** Payment is taken only at a club-configured time before kick-off, leaving a free cancellation window.

Cancellation and refund policy (proposed defaults, configurable per club)

Booking Users can cancel free until payment is taken; after that, value is returned as credit, never cash, except when the club cancels.

When	Booking User cancels	Booking User reschedules
Before the payment cutoff (default 24h before)	Free; nothing charged	Free
Cutoff to 6h before	50% credit	Free, once, to a slot within 30 days
Under 6h before, or no-show	No credit	Not allowed
Club cancels (pitch, weather, operational)	100% credit, or card refund on request	Free

- **FR-44** Apply the policy automatically with the payment gateway; without it, the Admin applies the same rules when confirming payment.
- **FR-45** Show the policy and the user's current cancellation outcome before they confirm a booking or a cancellation.
- **FR-46** Credit is held against the user's account and used before card payment on their next booking.

Player sourcing, tables and integrations

Captains short of players can borrow from other Teams, which keeps turn-up rates and the league schedule stable.

Players for another Team's match

1. **FR-35** A Captain who expects to be short creates a Player or Goalkeeper Request Notification for the match.
2. **FR-36** It goes to all Players (or Goalkeepers) not in either opposing Team, filtered by their chosen Nights.
3. **FR-37** The first to accept joins the match; once the slot is filled the request closes.
4. **FR-38** Team members can see who has confirmed for the match, so the Captain knows early if the Team is short.

League tables

The app can show Leagues, Fixtures, Match Results, Match Videos, Team Rankings, Best goals and Top scorers. Most clubs already publish these, so v1 integrates with the existing platform rather than replacing it.

Integrations

- **FR-39** Import Nights and Divisions from the Admin's existing tool (e.g. Excel).
- **FR-40** Integrate with the club's current website or fixtures system via its developer.
- **FR-41** Phase 1: in-app finance tracker with CSV / Excel export. Phase 2: accounting via Xero; other platforms and accounting packages connect through Xero.
- **FR-42** Club-configurable parameters at setup (fees, cutoffs, Nights, Divisions, payment window).

Non-functional requirements

- **Lightweight and embeddable:** small footprint; integrates with software the club already uses.

- **Security:** card data handled by a PCI-compliant payment gateway, never stored by the app; payment data in secure cloud infrastructure.
- **Timeliness:** scheduled notifications (T-36h, T-6h) must fire on time; delivery failures need a fallback.
- **Barcode integrity:** Barcodes must be unique, tied to a Team or Booking, and impossible to reuse or forge.
- **Configurability:** fees, cutoffs and payment windows are set per club without code changes.
- **Platforms:** iOS and Android.

Decisions

Question	Decision
Resending unanswered Confirmations	Resend once
Minimum players per Team	Configurable per Division (default 5)
Who rules a Team unpaid at T-6h	The Admin (manager)
Choosing a replacement opponent	First Team to accept
When to fall back to a friendly	Only when the Admin lists the match as friendly-eligible
Who pays for a friendly	Borrowed Players, the Team's Players or the club/manager, set per match
Barcode validity with the gateway	Per match
Payments for a cancelled match	Credit towards a future match
Booking cancellation and refunds	Proposed policy in Bookings
Existing platforms and accounting	Phase 1: in-app finance tracker and export; phase 2: Xero